

Furman University Jazz Ensemble Constitution

Revised January 2024

Article I. Name

The formal name of this organization shall be the Furman University Jazz Ensemble.

Article II. Purpose

The Furman University Jazz Ensemble is an organization that exists to provide opportunities for students to pursue jazz performance. Jazz is a uniquely American art form and has enjoyed worldwide popularity for over a century. The jazz ensemble and our smaller jazz combos perform concerts both on and off campus for a wide variety of events, including those that serve the music department, the Furman campus, the Upstate community, and the music community at large. We also bring several world-class guest artists to campus each year to inspire us jazz students, the Furman community, and the music community at large.

Article III. Affiliations

The Furman University Jazz Ensemble is affiliated with the Furman Music Department, and its artistic director, leader, and formal advisor is Dr. Matt Olson, Charles Ezra Daniel Professor of Music and Director of Jazz Studies.

Article IV. Membership

- A. In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership in the Furman University Jazz Ensemble and/or Combos shall be open to all undergraduate day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.
- B. Membership is by audition only, though auditions are mostly for placement into the correct ensemble. Auditions occur at the beginning of each fall term. Students who are selected to be a member of a jazz group are expected to remain a member for the entire academic year.
- C. Students must register for Jazz Ensemble and/or Jazz Combo (zero hours credit) in order to be a member.

Article V. Materials

Members are expected to own their own instrument and appropriate accessories (mutes, mouthpieces, cords, etc.). In some cases, students may use select University-owned equipment, which is to be signed out from the Furman Band Department.

Article VI. Attendance and Discipline

Membership is dependent upon consistent attendance at, and preparation for, all rehearsals and performances. In the case of an excused absence for a rehearsal, the member will secure the services of a capable substitute and receive permission from the director at least 24 hours prior to the rehearsal. In the case of a personal scheduling conflict with a performance, the member will secure permission from the Director of Jazz Studies three weeks in advance of the conflict. Members will receive one unexcused absence from a rehearsal each term. Any additional unexcused absences of any kind will result in an unsatisfactory grade for the term and possible dismissal from the ensemble.

Article VII. Officers

The Furman University Jazz Ensemble will have two official officers, a President and Treasurer, as well as a Jazz Ensemble Manager. A student can hold one of the offices and serve as the manager at the same time. To qualify as an officer, the student must be a member of the organization/ensemble, and be elected by a 2/3 vote of all members present and voting. Elections will be held in February during each school year. Terms for each office are one year.

A. The President's duties shall include:

- a. Serving as an SGA representative for the Jazz Ensemble
- b. Working with the faculty advisor/Director of Jazz Studies to identify guest artists for the coming school year, as well as any other initiatives for the coming year.
- c. Assisting the Director of Jazz Studies with the running of rehearsals
- d. Assisting the Jazz Ensemble Manager with the transportation of equipment

B. The Treasurer's duties shall include:

- a. Working closely with the President and the faculty advisor/Director of Jazz Studies to monitor all budgetary issues related to the jazz program, and creating the SGA funding request application for the coming school year
- b. Ensuring that guest artist expenses and honoraria are properly paid in a timely fashion

C. The Jazz Ensemble Manager's duties shall include:

- a. Managing the equipment concerns of the ensemble, including setting up the band for rehearsals and concerts, as well as supervising the transportation of equipment to performances outside of the Music Building.
- b. Managing all aspects of the jazz library, including cataloguing new pieces, maintaining an accurate and detailed computer database of the library, and participating in special jazz library projects.
- c. Assisting the faculty advisor/Director of Jazz Studies in advertising performances of the jazz ensembles, including making flyers, online and social media advertisements, and press releases.

Article VIII. Advisor

The faculty advisor to the Furman University Jazz Ensemble will be the Director of Jazz Studies.

A. The faculty advisor's duties shall include:

- a. Conduct the musical aspects of the ensemble (choosing music, scheduling and leading rehearsals, teaching the music, etc)
- b. Consult and assist the officers and members in identifying potential guest artists for the coming school year. Further, the advisor will normally be the contact person in handling the logistics of the guests' trips to campus, as he has extensive experience in handling guest artist relations, and it is imperative that our guests have a wonderful, efficient visit to campus, as their experience on campus will affect future guest's willingness to come to Furman. We trust and rely upon our advisor to help us through this process.

- c. Work with the officers, and subsequently the SGA treasurer and administrative assistant to ensure that honoraria are paid in a timely manner, and that any travel arrangements are booked and paid for.

Article IX. Meetings

The Furman University Jazz Ensemble will conduct meetings during our normal rehearsal times, on Mondays and Thursdays from 2:30-3:45 PM, in the Music Building Room D13.

Article X. Finance

The Furman University Jazz Ensemble will apply for funding each year from the Student Government Association. This funding will primarily be to bring major guest artists to campus to perform with and instruct our membership. Guests will be expected to present master classes, clinics, and private lessons in addition to rehearsing and performing with the Jazz Ensemble. We may also use funding to address any significant equipment needs we face (amplifiers, drums, audio/visual equipment, etc.). This funding is not available to us through any other source, and these guest artist appearances are exceptionally important to the organization, as they provide inspiration and instruction to us, as well as to provide significant cultural experiences to the Furman and surrounding community.

The faculty advisor/Director of Jazz Studies additionally has access to some limited funding from the office of the Dean of the Faculty for operational needs, specifically purchasing printed music, printing concert programs, paying a student Sound Engineer to run sound for our concerts, and providing a small stipend for the Jazz Ensemble Manager's work. Further, he has a small restricted account that is available for equipment maintenance/repair, and emergency equipment needs. He does not have funding for guest artists or for major equipment purchases.

Article XI. Amendments

This constitution shall be hereafter subject to amendments upon a 3/4 vote of the group.

The Furman University Jazz Ensemble Constitution was most recently revised on January 23, 2024, and was passed by a unanimous 18-0 vote.

Furman University Jazz Ensemble Bylaws

Revised January 2024

Article I. Membership

All members have equal status; there are not different levels of membership. As stated in the Constitution, membership is by audition. The requirements for membership are satisfactory attendance at rehearsals and concerts, as well as preparation of the music. Members may be removed from the ensemble for failure to attend and/or prepare the music in a timely fashion. The faculty advisor will consult with the officers on this decision, and removal will only occur in the most egregious situations.

Article II. Selection of Officers

Officers will be nominated by the membership in February of each school, and an election will occur. Officers are elected by a simple majority of those members present and voting. Officer duties are outlined in the Constitution. In the event of a vacancy, an emergency election will be held to fill the office using the same procedure. An officer may be removed from office by resignation or by a 2/3 vote of the membership.

Article III. Selection of Advisor

The advisor will always be the Director of Jazz Studies, as he is the person who provides the artistic direction for the ensemble. In lieu of removing the advisor, we would simply cease to be a student organization with a 3/4 vote of those members present and voting.

Article IV. Committees

Given the relatively small size of our organization, we do not presently have a need for committees.

Article V. Rules of Order

The president shall run meetings, establish an agenda, and proceed with any business.

Article II. Amendments

These bylaws shall be hereafter subject to amendments upon a 3/4 vote of the group.

The Furman University Jazz Ensemble Bylaws were most recently revised on January 23, 2024, and was passed by a unanimous 18-0 vote.